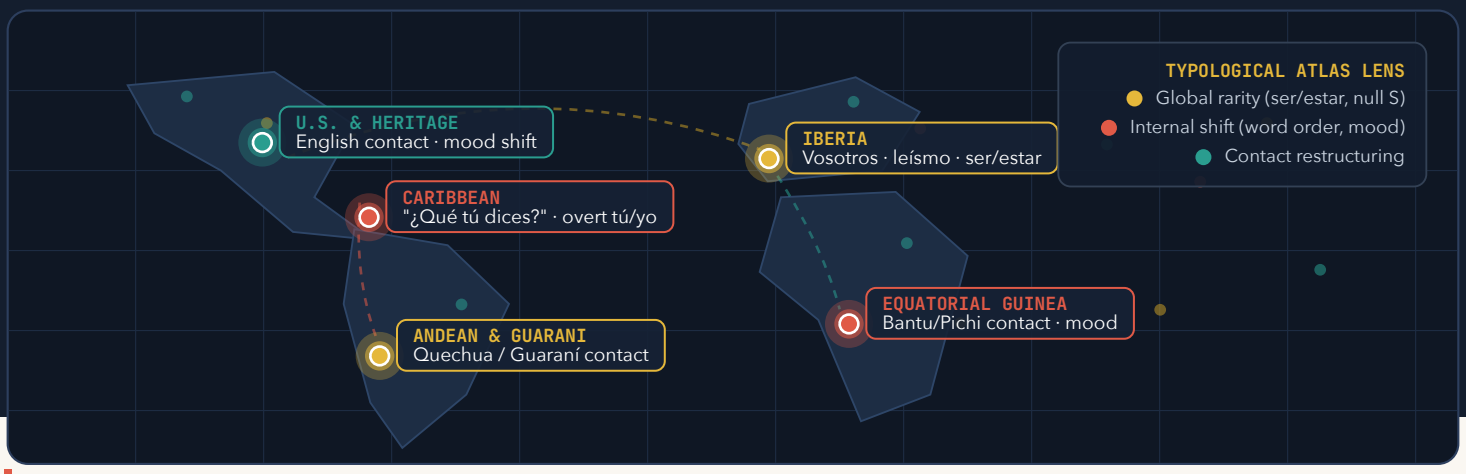
SPA 379 | SPRING 2027 | SEMINAR IN HISPANIC LINGUISTICS

TAUGHT IN SPANISH

What makes Spanish *ordinary* – and *extraordinary* – among the world's languages?

THE MANY SPANISHES: What Spanish Variation Reveals About Language Itself



From the Andes to the Caribbean, and from Madrid to Los Angeles and Equatorial Guinea, Spanish takes on fascinating shapes. In this seminar, we use the world's languages as a lens to explore why Spanish varies, what features make it globally unique, and what happens when it comes into contact with Quechua, Guaraní, English, and African languages.

WHAT WE'LL EXPLORE

01 Spanish's Global Surprises
Did you know most languages in the world don't have a subjunctive mood, don't drop subject pronouns, and don't split "to be" into *ser* and *estar*? Discover where Spanish stands on the world map.

02 One Language, Many Systems
Why do Caribbean speakers say *"¿Qué tú quieres?"* while Andean speakers drop pronouns almost entirely? Trace how grammar adapts across communities.

03 Worlds in Contact
What happens when Spanish lives alongside Quechua, Guaraní, English in the U.S., or African languages in Equatorial Guinea? Explore how contact reshapes a language.

INSIDE THE SEMINAR

Interactive Maps & Visual Tools
Explore real patterns across the Spanish-speaking world through intuitive, visual apps and global language atlases.

Put AI to the Test
Audit ChatGPT and modern AI models – which varieties of Spanish do they recognize, and which communities do they erase?

No Textbook · No Written Final
Learn through curated readings, step-by-step guided analyses, and an interactive capstone showcase.

COUNTS FOR MAJOR & MINOR LANGUAGE / LINGUISTICS SEMINAR

Prof. Jerid Francom Spring 2027 · Tue / Thu (75 min)
Department of Spanish · Wake Forest University

PREREQUISITE: SPA 320 CONCEPT A1 · TYPOLOGICAL ATLAS

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